TEAM NORMANI · OCTOBER 2026

São Paulo

a field guide to eating, shopping and going out in the city

EAT SHOP DRINK KNOW DON'TS HELP

MEET THE CITY

São Paulo, in numbers

11.9M
people in the city (IBGE 2026 est.), the largest city in the Southern Hemisphere

1554
founded on January 25 by Jesuit priests

#1
Brazil has the largest Japanese community outside Japan. Its heart is Liberdade, in São Paulo

760 m
above sea level: warm days, cool nights. Bring a light jacket

GOOD TO KNOW

Paulistanos
Locals are called paulistanos. The city never really sleeps: dinner at 10 PM is normal, parties end at sunrise.

Sunday on Paulista
Avenida Paulista closes to cars on Sundays and turns into a giant open-air street party.

A city of immigrants
Italian, Japanese, Lebanese, Korean and Northeastern Brazilian cooking all live here, often on the same block.

Street art
Graffiti and murals are everywhere; walk Beco do Batman in Vila Madalena for the classic tour.

THE CREATIVE CITY

SPFW · Oct 13–18, 2026
Latin America’s biggest fashion week, since 1995, runs the same week you’re here.

Bienal de São Paulo
Created in 1951, the second-oldest art biennial in the world after Venice.

MASP
Lina Bo Bardi’s red-framed museum on Paulista, floating over a free public plaza.

Pride
São Paulo’s Pride Parade on Paulista is one of the largest in the world, with millions on the street.

The new Centro
Old downtown buildings now host the city’s hottest bars, restaurants and studios. Le Freak, Bar dos Arcos and Brim are all here.

BEFORE YOU GO

The basics

Everything you need in your pocket for the week.

HOME BASE

Rosewood São Paulo

Rua Itapeva, 435 · Bela Vista (Cidade Matarazzo)

Mata Città, Le Freak, Bar do Cofre and Bar dos Arcos are all a short ride away in the Centro.

GETTING AROUND

Uber or 99

The two ride apps everyone uses. 99 is the local one and works just like Uber. Download both before you land.

MONEY

Brazilian Real · R$

Cards (and Apple / Google Pay) work almost everywhere. Keep a little cash for small bars and street vendors.

FOOD DELIVERY

iFood

The most popular delivery app in Brazil. Uber Eats works too.

TIPPING

10% is on the bill

Restaurants add a 10% service charge ("serviço"). No need to tip on top.

EAT

Restaurants

Our picks, from fine dining to the corner boteco. Tap an address to open it in Maps.



ITALIAN · 7 ROOMS, NEXT DOOR

Mata Città

ORDER Agnolotti dal plin, ossobuco, lemon meringue tart

Rua Itapeva, 569 (Cidade Matarazzo) · Bela Vista · @matacitta



FRENCH BISTRO · THE COOLEST TABLE IN TOWN

Le Freak

ORDER Moules frites & olive-oil chocolate mousse

Av. São Luís, 282 · Centro · @lefreak.menu



PORK · WORLD'S 50 BEST

A Casa do Porco

ORDER Porco San Zé, slow-roasted for 6 hours

Rua Araújo, 124 · Centro · @acasadoporcobar



ITALIAN · FRESH PASTA & PIZZA

Bosco

ORDER Lasagna with 8-hour braised beef

Rua João Moura, 976 · Pinheiros · @bosco.restaurante



ITALIAN · SIMPLE AND DELICIOUS

Peppino Cantina

ORDER Bruschetta with burrata & fresh pasta

Rua João Cachoeira, 175 · Itaim Bibi · @peppinocantina



NOODLE BAR · WORLD'S 50 BEST BARS

Tan Tan

ORDER Dan dan noodles & aka teba chicken wings

Rua Fradique Coutinho, 153 · Pinheiros · @tantannb

EAT

Restaurants, cont.

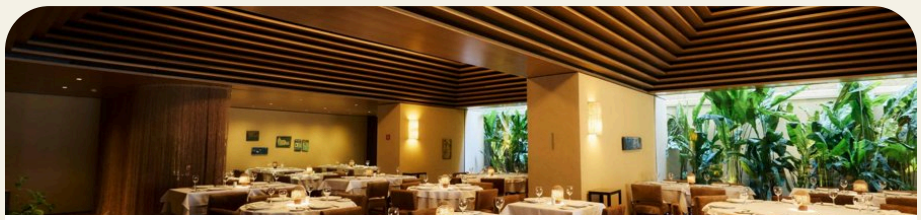


JAPANESE · CHARCOAL GRILL, SUPER FRESH

Mokutan

ORDER Ceviche Mokutan & yakitori

Rua Ferreira de Araújo, 477 · Pinheiros · @mokutan_pinheiros



BRAZILIAN STEAKHOUSE · SINCE 1958

Rodeio

ORDER Sliced picanha with biru-biru rice

Rua Haddock Lobo, 1448 · Jardins · @rodeiorestaurante



BRAZILIAN BOTECO MEETS SPANISH BODEGA

Bodega Pepito

ORDER "Telefono": risotto croquette with steak tartare

Rua dos Pinheiros, 320 · Pinheiros · @bodega_pepito

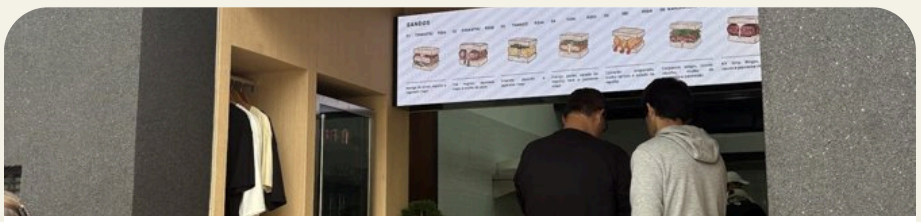


BAKERY · BRUNCH

Le Blé

ORDER Eggs Benedict on brioche & the bread basket

Rua Padre João Manuel, 968 · Jardins · @leblecasadepaes



JAPANESE SANDWICHES

Saikō Sando

ORDER Gyukatsu sando (breaded filet mignon)

Rua Amauri, 30 · Jardim Europa · @saiko.sando



SANDWICHES YOU ONLY FIND HERE

Sanduteca

ORDER Lebanese lamb sandwich

Av. São Luís, 187 (Galeria Metrópole) · Centro · @sanduteca_



COFFEE SHOP & CAFÉ

Brim

ORDER Tiramisù served in a teacup

Av. São Luís, 84 · Centro · @brim_sp

TIP

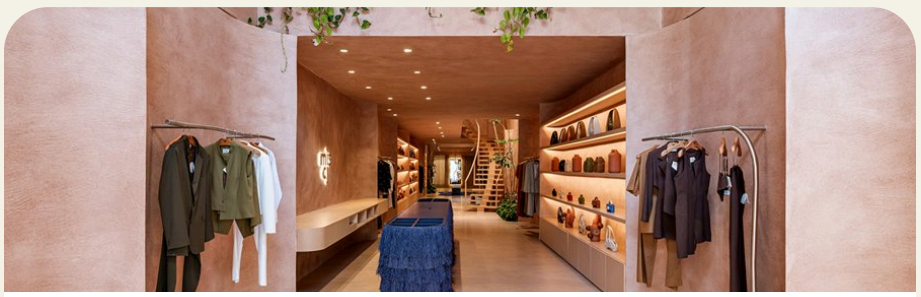
Book ahead

The hottest tables (Le Freak, A Casa do Porco, Tan Tan) fill up fast. Ask the Rosewood concierge to reserve for you.

SHOP

Stores

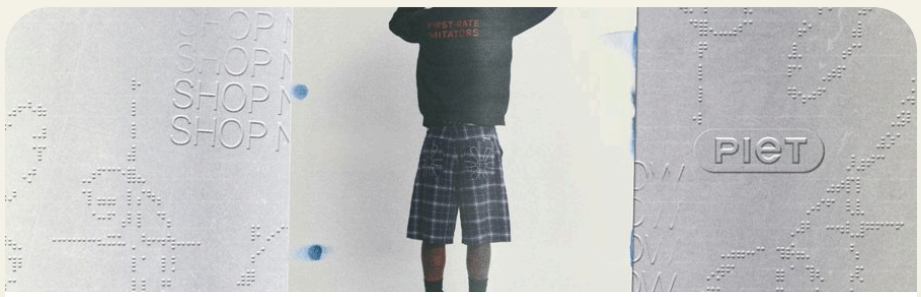
Brazilian brands, design and the best second-hand in town.



BRAZILIAN DESIGNER FASHION & DESIGN

Misci

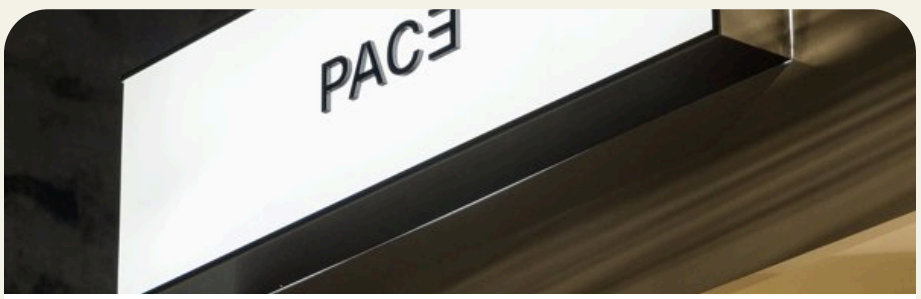
Alameda Lorena, 1601 · Jardins · @misci__



BRAZILIAN STREETWEAR

Piet

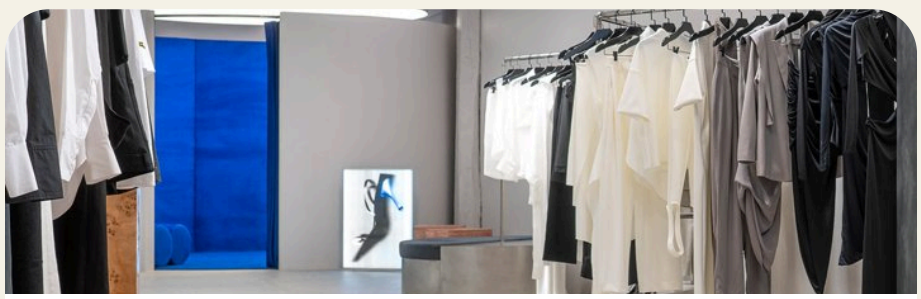
Rua Padre João Manuel, 722 · Jardins · @piet_org



STREETWEAR, SPORTSWEAR + CAFÉ

Pace

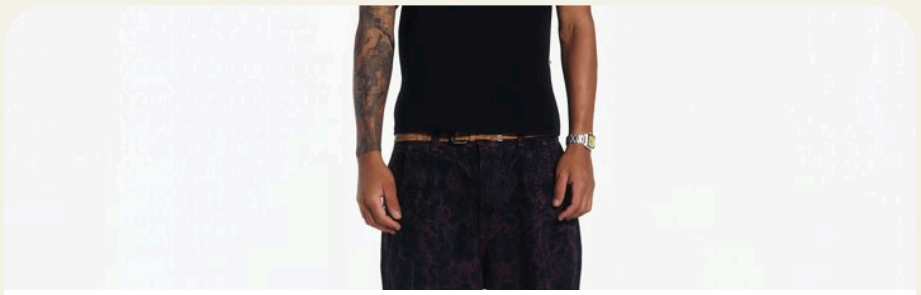
Alameda Itu, 1466 · Jardins · @pace



BRAZILIAN WOMENSWEAR, SHARP TAILORING

Francesca

Rua Mateus Grou, 604 · Pinheiros · @shopfrancesca



SATIRICAL BRAZILIAN STREETWEAR

MAD Enlatados

Online + at Guadalupe Store · @mad_enlatados



SNEAKERS & STREETWEAR MULTIBRAND

Guadalupe Store

Av. Bernardino de Campos, 173 · Paraíso · @guadalupestore

SHOP

Stores, cont.



BRAZILIAN CONTEMPORARY JEWELRY

Vehr

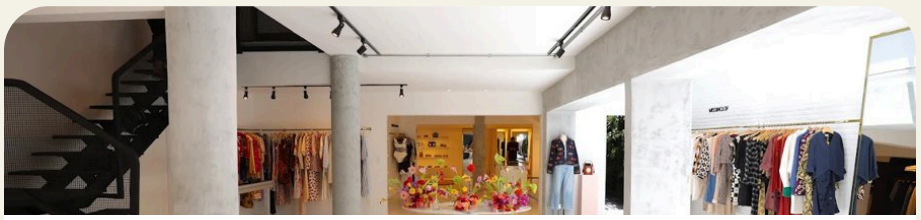
Shopping JK Iguatemi · Vila Olímpia · @vehr



MINIMAL WOMENSWEAR & SWIMWEAR

Haight

Alameda Lorena, 1835 · Jardins · @haight_clothing



CURATED WOMENSWEAR & BEAUTY

The Club Jardins

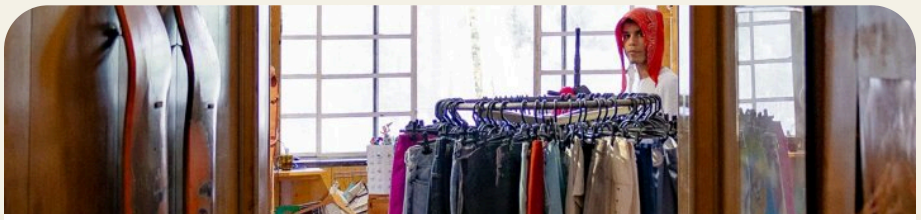
Alameda Gabriel Monteiro da Silva, 1984 · Jardins · @theclub_eshop



INDEPENDENT BRAZILIAN & LATIN DESIGNERS

Pinga

Rua da Consolação, 3378 · Jardins · @pinga.store



6 FLOORS OF SECOND-HAND & VINTAGE

Brechó Vertical

Rua Dom José de Barros, 337 · Centro · @brechovertical.sp

TIP

Two in one street

Misci and Francesca face each other on Rua Mateus Grou, Pinheiros. And Varal bar is hidden behind the Misci store there.

DRINK

Bars

Where São Paulo actually goes out.



COCKTAILS INSIDE A 1940S BANK VAULT

Bar do Cofre

DRINK “Ordem e Prosecco” (cachaça & bubbles)

Rua João Brícola, 24 (Farol Santander, basement) · Centro · @subastor



UNDER THE ARCHES OF THE THEATRO MUNICIPAL

Bar dos Arcos

DRINK “Restaurante Leite”, a cashew & cachaça cocktail

Praça Ramos de Azevedo, s/n (Theatro Municipal, basement) · Centro · @bardosarcos



ROOFTOP OVER THE ANHANGABAÚ, VINYL DJS

Balsa

Rua Capitão Salomão, 26, 4th floor · Centro · @a_balsa



24-SEAT SPEAKEASY, PASSWORD AT BOOKING

Oculto

DRINK Painkiller

Rua Fidalga, 120 · Vila Madalena · @casteloocultо



HIDDEN COURTYARD BEHIND THE MISCI STORE

Varal

Rua Mateus Grou, 597 · Pinheiros · @varal___

TIP

Centro by night

Bar do Cofre, Bar dos Arcos and Balsa are a few minutes apart downtown. Go by Uber or 99, not on foot.

STAY SHARP

São Paulo don’ts

The city is warm and welcoming. A few habits keep it that way.

01

Don’t: Phones near the hotel

The area around the hotel is great, which also makes it a target. Don’t walk around with your phone out on the street.

02

Don’t: Gold & chains on busy streets

Skip gold chains and flashy jewellery in crowded places like Avenida Paulista.

03

Don’t: Candy or water from drivers

Politely say no if a ride-app driver offers you candy or water.

04

Don’t: Cigarettes from strangers

Don’t accept cigarettes from people you don’t know.

05

Don’t: Kids on bikes around Paulista

Keep an eye out for young guys on bicycles around Avenida Paulista: phone snatching is their move.

06

Don’t: Check the card machine

When paying by card, always look at the amount on the machine before you tap or enter your PIN.

SAY IT

Useful Portuguese

Muito obrigado / obrigada

Thank you very much

MOON-too oh-bree-GAH-doo / -dah

Por favor

Please

por fah-VOR

Meu nome é...

My name is...

meh-oo NOH-mee eh

Eu não falo português

I don’t speak Portuguese

eh-oo nowm FAH-loo por-too-GAYZ

EMERGENCY

190 Police

192 Ambulance (SAMU)

193 Fire brigade

All free, 24/7, from any phone. Tourist police (DEATUR): Rua Cantareira, 390, Centro · (11) 3257-4475. The hotel concierge can also call for you.